

THE WHITE HOUSE
WASHINGTON

April 19, 1993

MEMORANDUM FOR THE SECRETARY OF STATE
THE SECRETARY OF DEFENSE
THE DIRECTOR OF CENTRAL INTELLIGENCE
THE CHAIRMAN, JOINT CHIEFS OF STAFF
USUN AMBASSADOR
ASSISTANT TO THE VICE PRESIDENT FOR
NATIONAL SECURITY AFFAIRS

SUBJECT: Decisions of Principals Committee Meeting on
Bosnia, April 9, 1993 ~~(S)~~

Omnibus Sanctions Resolution

- As requested by Russian President Yeltsin in his letter to the President, we will recommend to the President that we not press the omnibus sanctions resolution to a vote in the U.N. Security Council until after the Russian referendum on April 25. We will explain our decision to defer by the especially delicate situation in Russia just before the referendum, and use the time to press the Bosnian Serbs to negotiate seriously on the basis on the Vance/Owen plan.
~~(S)~~
- Secretary Christopher will write Russian Foreign Minister Kozyrev saying that after the referendum we want to bring the resolution promptly to a vote, without a delay between its passage and the effective date of its provisions, and that we will expect Russia either to vote for it or to abstain. In the meantime, Secretary Christopher will urge that Russia use the delay to press the Serbs to negotiate seriously and reach agreement in order to avoid tighter sanctions. ~~(S)~~
- Leon Fuerth will prepare a list of sanctions-tightening measures that can be taken without a new resolution. We will urge other Western states to join us in taking them.
~~(S)~~
- State will prepare a cable to capitals explaining our position, and Secretary Christopher will take it up when he hosts the other G-7 Foreign Ministers for lunch in Tokyo on April 14. ~~(S)~~
- If Russian Deputy Foreign Minister Churkin asks Ambassador Bartholomew about our response to the Yeltsin letter,

Bartholomew will reply that Secretary Christopher will be responding to Foreign Minister Kozyrev. ~~(S)~~

Peace Process

The following Principals Committee members will draft papers making the best case for the following options, which will be sent to Jenonne Walker for coordination/distribution by Wednesday, April 14:

Leon Fuerth: Pressing hard for a Vance-Owen settlement. We would use the threat of lifting the arms embargo as leverage with the Serbs. ~~(S)~~

Secretary Aspin: Enforcing a cease-fire through air or ground action or both, along essentially the lines now held by the parties. ~~(S)~~

Secretary Christopher: Making a major effort to lift the arms embargo in order to let the Bosnian government have a better chance of holding its own with the Bosnian Serbs. This option will include consideration of a new international forum or mechanism that might finally establish a peace after the parties themselves have found a natural balance on the ground. ~~(S)~~

Ambassador Albright: Using American air power to help redress the military balance. This could be in conjunction with lifting the arms embargo (e.g., to protect the Bosnians until they could acquire and learn to use heavy weapons) or as an alternative to letting them better arm themselves. ~~(S)~~


Anthony Lake
Assistant to the President
for National Security Affairs

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Clinton Presidential Records Mandatory Declassification Review

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Documents from this Mandatory Declassification Review were released in full or released in part.

Those documents released with redactions have been restricted under Section 1.4 (c) of E.O. 13526 and (b)(3) of the FOIA.
